National Procurement and IT Lead - Roles & Responsibilities

Volunteer: Ajitbhai Vala

Department: National Kitchen Team

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1. India Order Management (Sweets & Farshan)

To ensure every national centre receives high-quality sweets and farsan from India through a predictable, transparent, and well-managed ordering, production, and delivery system.

1.1. **Annual Planning & Coordination**

- Prepare a list of Frozen Sweets and Farshan items to be ordered from India.
- Coordinate with Pujya Santo in India to confirm production capacity, lead times, and special requirements.
- Develop ordering schedule aligned with festivals and national events.
- Communicate the annual plan to all centres with clear timelines, cut-off dates, and expectations.
- Forecast demand based on historical data, seasonal trends, and new product introductions.

1.2. **Collecting & Consolidating Requirements**

- Prepare standardised templates for centres to submit their requirements.
- Conduct briefing sessions to ensure centres understand product specifications, MOQ, and timelines.
- Consolidate all centre requirements into a national master order.

1.3. **Placing Orders with India**

- Finalise quantities after cross-checking with centres and internal teams.
- Place official orders with India, ensuring documentation is complete and traceable.

1.4. **Logistics & Delivery Tracking**

- Track production status, dispatch dates, shipping documents, and customs clearance.
- Maintain real-time visibility of shipment movement and proactively communicate updates to centres.
- Once shipment has arrived in Australia, coordinate with freight forwarders, customs brokers, and local transport partners.
- Prepare and share arrival schedules, expected delivery dates, and distribution plans.

1.5. **Issue Resolution & Quality Feedback**

- Collect structured feedback from centres on product quality, packaging and any discrepancies such as shortages, damages, or delays,
- Conduct root-cause analysis for recurring issues and implement corrective actions.
- Communicate with India team and provide the feedback received from each centre.
- Maintain a concerns or issue records for continuous improvement.

2.Yearly Planner & Calendar

Create a unified national kitchen plan that ensures consistency in menus, event preparation, and operational execution across all centres.

2.1. **Calendar Creation**

- Develop and share a comprehensive kitchen calendar template covering menu themes and key preparation days with Centre Kitchen Lead.
- Communicate the national planner to all centres with clear implementation guidelines.
- Gather each centre’s yearly planner.
- Align the calendar with India order cycles, volunteer availability, and centre-specific constraints.
- Support centres in adapting the planner to local conditions while maintaining national consistency.
- Monitor adherence and provide corrective guidance where required.

2.2.**Annual Review & Improvement**

- Collect structured feedback from centres on calendar practicality and operational challenges.
- Analyse trends, bottlenecks, and improvement opportunities.
- Update the planner annually to reflect learnings, new products, and operational enhancements.

3.Kitchen Application Rollout & Management

Implement and maintain a national digital kitchen management system that enhances efficiency, accuracy, and standardisation across all centres.

3.1. **Application Enhancement**

- Collaborate with developers to define feature requirements, workflows, and user experience improvements.
- Test new features, validate functionality, and ensure alignment with kitchen standards.
- Maintain a backlog of enhancement requests and prioritise based on national needs.

3.2. **Phase-Wise Rollout**

- Develop a structured rollout plan covering timelines, centre readiness, and resource allocation.
- Coordinate with centre leads to ensure smooth onboarding.
- Track rollout progress and escalate delays or technical issues.

3.3. **Training & Adoption**

- Create training materials, user guides, and video tutorials.
- Conduct hands-on training sessions for centre teams and volunteers.
- Monitor adoption levels and provide additional support where usage is low.

3.4. **Ongoing Support & Maintenance**

- Serve as the first point of contact for technical issues and user queries.
- Coordinate with IT team for bug fixes, updates, and system improvements.

3.5. **Continuous Improvement**

- Collect user feedback regularly and identify opportunities for optimisation.
- Recommend enhancements to improve efficiency, accuracy, and user experience.
- Ensure the application evolves with changing operational needs.

4. Supplier Relationship Management (Ajitbhai & Bharatbhai)

Build and maintain strong supplier partnerships that ensure consistent quality, competitive pricing, and reliable supply for national kitchen operations.

4.1. **Supplier Identification, Pricing Negotiation & Agreements**

- Identify potential suppliers for raw materials, packaging, and specialised items.
- Negotiate competitive pricing, long-term contracts, and bulk-purchase benefits.
- Negotiate payment terms, delivery schedules, and service expectations.

4.2. **Quality Monitoring & Compliance**

- Conduct periodic reviews of supplier performance, product quality, and delivery reliability.
- Address quality issues promptly and ensure corrective actions are implemented.
- Maintain quality benchmarks and ensure suppliers meet standards.

4.3. **National Purchasing Coordination**

- Coordinate bulk procurement and distribution plans.
- Ensure transparency in purchasing decisions and maintain records.

4.4. **Issue Resolution & Relationship Management**

- Address delays, shortages, or quality concerns with professionalism and urgency.
- Maintain strong, respectful relationships with suppliers to ensure long-term reliability.
- Conduct periodic review meetings to strengthen collaboration and improve service levels.